

HORIZON TECHX

Finance & Investment Analysis Internship

TASK 2: CRYPTOCURRENCY PORTFOLIO ANALYSIS

Analysis Period: 30 September 2025 – 30 September 2026

Selected Cryptocurrencies: Bitcoin (BTC), Monero (XMR), Solana (SOL)

Prepared by: Joshna Darupally

Date: 02 October, 2026.

1. Introduction

- Cryptocurrencies have become an important alternative digital asset class, but they also involve substantially higher price volatility and risk than many traditional investments.
- The objective of this report is to analyse a three-cryptocurrency portfolio consisting of **Bitcoin (BTC), Monero (XMR), Solana (SOL)** over a 12-month period.
- The analysis focuses on historical price performance, percentage returns, market position, volatility and major risk factors. The purpose is to understand how the three assets behaved during the period and how diversification across different cryptocurrency networks can affect portfolio risk and return.
- Cryptocurrencies are categorized into distinct types based on their primary function, underlying technology, and use case within digital networks.

- 1) Bitcoin is the original digital currency designed for peer-to-peer electronic transactions and as a decentralized store of value.
- 2) Monero is a privacy-focused cryptocurrency designed to provide greater transaction privacy.
- 3) Solana represents a high-performance blockchain ecosystem.

On 29 September 2026, **CoinMarketCap** recorded market capitalisations of approximately,

- **\$1.68 trillion for Bitcoin.**
- **\$326.8 billion for Ethereum.**
- **\$70.0 billion for Solana.**

2. Selected Cryptocurrencies

Bitcoin(BTC)

Bitcoin is the first and largest cryptocurrency by market capitalisation. It operates through a decentralised peer-to-peer network and has a maximum supply of 21 million coins. Bitcoin's large market size and established trading ecosystem make it an important asset for cryptocurrency portfolio analysis.

Reference:[Bitcoin – CoinGecko](#)

Monero(XMR)

Monero is a privacy-focused cryptocurrency. Its protocol is designed to make transaction details more private by using technologies such as ring signatures, stealth addresses and confidential transaction amounts. Therefore, Monero has a different usage from Bitcoin and Solana.

Reference:[Monero – Official Website](#)

Solana(SOL)

Solana is a blockchain platform designed for fast and scalable transactions. It supports decentralised applications, digital assets and other blockchain- based services. SOL is the native cryptocurrency of the Solana network.

Reference:[Solana – CoinGecko](#)

3. 12-Month Performance Analysis

The analysis period is **30 September 2025 to 30 September 2026**.

Cryptocurrency	Price – 30 Sep 2025	Price – 30 Sep 2026	Approx. 12-Month Return
Bitcoin (BTC)	\$114,056.08	\$83,553.85	-26.74%
Monero (XMR)	\$295.33	\$544.45	+84.35%
Solana (SOL)	\$208.74	\$117.99	-43.47

Formula:

12-Month Return (%) = [(Ending Price – Beginning Price) / Beginning Price] × 100

Ending price- Initial Purchase Price

Beginning price- Ending Sell Price

Reference- CoinMarketCap

- Based on these selected dates, **Monero recorded a positive return of approximately 84.35%**, whereas Bitcoin and Solana recorded negative returns of approximately **26.74%** and **43.47%**, respectively.
- This demonstrates that cryptocurrency performance can differ substantially even within the same broad asset class.

4. Risk Analysis

Cryptocurrency investments involve several forms of risk, including price volatility, regulatory uncertainty, liquidity risk, cybersecurity risk, technological risk and changes in market sentiment.

Bitcoin Risk

- Bitcoin's risk is predominantly macro-financial and systemic.
- It remains exposed to heavy market drawdowns during broader economic shifts. Its primary vulnerabilities are external (e.g., changes in global liquidity or harsh retail crypto tax laws) rather than internal technical bugs.
- Its major risks include broad cryptocurrency-market corrections, macroeconomic conditions, regulatory developments and changes in investor sentiment.

Reference- Investopedia

Monero Risk

- Monero's risk profile is entirely dominated by regulatory clampdowns and exchange de-listings.
- Regulatory bodies globally oppose anonymous digital cash. Major crypto platforms routinely de-list XMR to remain compliant.
- As a result, its primary risk is a liquidity trap—investors may find it increasingly difficult to legally buy, sell, or convert XMR back into fiat currency.

Solana Risk

- Solana carries intense technical, smart contract, and structural risks offset by rapid growth potential.
- Solana has a smaller market capitalisation than Bitcoin and has historically experienced significant price movements.
- Its risk is influenced by overall cryptocurrency-market conditions as well as developments in the Solana ecosystem.

5. Market Capitalisation Comparison

Market capitalisation is an important indicator of the relative size of a cryptocurrency.

On 30 September 2026, CoinGecko reported approximately:

Cryptocurrency	Approx. Market Capitalisation – 30 Sep 2026
Bitcoin	\$1.68 trillion
Solana	\$70.01 billion
Monero	\$10.19 billion

Bitcoin was substantially larger than both Solana and Monero. CoinGecko recorded Bitcoin's market capitalisation at approximately \$1.68 trillion and Solana's at approximately \$70.0 billion on 30 September 2026. Monero's market capitalisation was approximately \$10.19 billion.

The difference in market capitalisation is relevant when considering liquidity, market depth and potential price sensitivity.

6. Portfolio Allocation

For this internship portfolio exercise, the following **illustrative allocation** can be used:

Cryptocurrency	Allocation	Portfolio Role
Bitcoin (BTC)	50%	Core cryptocurrency exposure
Monero (XMR)	25%	Privacy-focused cryptocurrency exposure
Solana (SOL)	25%	Higher-growth blockchain exposure
Total	100%	Diversified cryptocurrency portfolio

7. Key Findings

Bitcoin

Bitcoin recorded an approximate **-26.74% return** during the selected 12-month period. Despite its dec

line, Bitcoin remained substantially larger by market capitalisation than the other two assets.

Monero

Monero recorded an approximate **+84.35% return** between the selected dates. Its performance was substantially different from that of Bitcoin and Solana.

Solana

Solana recorded an approximate **-43.47% return** during the period. The decline demonstrates the possibility of significant downside movements in cryptocurrency assets.

Overall Portfolio Observation

The three assets produced very different outcomes during the selected 12-month period. This illustrates that cryptocurrency portfolios can benefit from exposure to assets with different characteristics, but diversification does not eliminate the risks associated with the overall cryptocurrency market.

8. Conclusion

- The 12-month analysis of Bitcoin, Monero and Solana demonstrates the highly variable nature of cryptocurrency investments.
- Based on the selected historical dates, Bitcoin recorded an approximate **-26.74% return**, Monero recorded approximately **+84.35%**, and Solana recorded approximately **-43.47%**
- Monero's performance was substantially different from Bitcoin and Solana during the period, highlighting the importance of analysing multiple assets rather than relying on the performance of a single cryptocurrency.
- At the same time, the analysis demonstrates that high historical returns should always be considered together with volatility, market capitalisation, liquidity and regulatory risks.
- A diversified cryptocurrency portfolio can provide exposure to different blockchain technologies and use cases, but it does not eliminate the possibility of significant losses.
- Continuous monitoring, appropriate position sizing and periodic rebalancing are therefore important elements of cryptocurrency portfolio management.

9. References

Cryptocurrency Price & Market Data

1. **CoinGecko – Bitcoin Historical Data**
[Bitcoin Historical Data](#)

2. **CoinGecko – Monero Historical Data**
[Monero Historical Data](#)
3. **CoinGecko – Solana Historical Data**
[Solana Historical Data](#)
4. **CoinGecko – Cryptocurrency Market Data**
[CoinGecko](#)
5. **CoinMarketCap – Cryptocurrency Market Data**
[CoinMarketCap](#)

Monero Information

6. **Monero – Official Website**
[GetMonero.org](#)
7. **Monero Documentation**
[Monero Documentation](#)
8. **CoinLore – Monero Historical Data**
[Monero Historical Prices](#)

Market Context

9. **Reuters – Cryptocurrency Market Analysis**
[Reuters – Bitcoin Market Analysis](#)
10. **Statmuse- Market prices**
[Statmuse](#)